

Pittsburgh Market Update

September 2026 | What the numbers say, and how interest rates fit in

\$292K

Avg sale price
+2.7% vs last Sept

46 days

Avg days on market
down from 52

+23%

Active listings
vs last Sept

3.5 mo

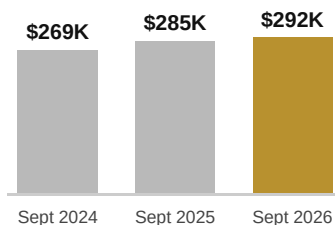
Months of supply
(6 = balanced)

The short version

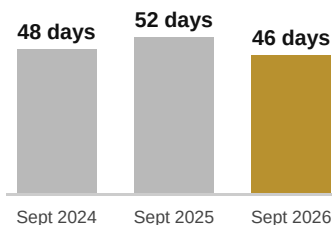
The national headlines are about a slowing market. Pittsburgh is not that market. Prices are still rising, homes are selling faster than a year ago, and the one real change is that buyers finally have more to choose from. That combination, more inventory and shorter days on market at the same time, means demand is absorbing the new supply, not backing away from it. It is still technically a seller's market, but it is drifting toward balance, and for a buyer that is the best setup we have seen in a couple of years.

What the numbers say

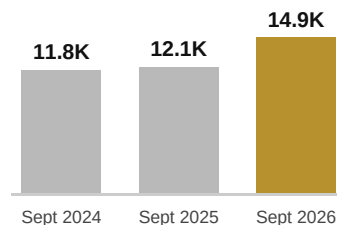
Average Sale Price



Average Days on Market



Active Listings



Prices. The average sale price was \$269K in September 2024, \$285K in September 2025, and \$292K this September. That is +5.7% last year and +2.7% this year, about 8.5% over two years. Still appreciating, just at a slower pace. Two things worth knowing: September is down from the June peak (around \$330K this year), but that is the same seasonal pattern as last year, when prices peaked around \$302K in early summer and settled to \$285K by September. Summer is when the larger family homes trade; fall and winter are when investors buy. And the gap between list price and sale price has widened, meaning sellers are asking more than buyers are paying. That is leverage for a buyer.

Days on market. Homes are averaging about 46 days on market this September, down from 52 last September and 48 the year before. Days on market peaked around 76 in February, which is normal winter seasonality here, and has come down every month since.

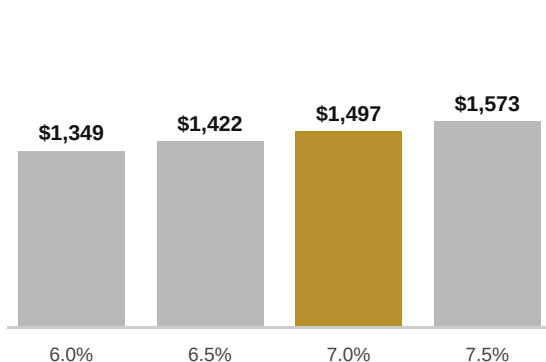
Inventory. This is the real change. Active listings are up roughly 23% from last September, from about 12,100 to 14,900, and they have climbed every month since March. Months of supply is still around 3.5 (six is considered balanced), so sellers still have the edge on paper, but the trend is clearly toward a more balanced market. More listings means more deals that actually pencil and a little more room to negotiate on price and terms.

How interest rates affect this market

Where rates stand. On September 16 the Federal Reserve raised its benchmark rate a quarter point to 3.75% to 4.00%, its first increase since 2023, and signaled it may raise once more before year end. The 30-year fixed mortgage is sitting right around 7%, and the 10-year Treasury, which mortgage rates actually track, is near 5%. Most forecasts have mortgage rates holding near or slightly above 7% through the fall and winter unless inflation cools faster than expected. In plain terms: do not underwrite a purchase on the hope that rates drop in the next six months.

A quick myth to retire. A Fed hike does not move mortgage rates by the same amount, and rates often move before the meeting, not after. What actually brings mortgage rates down is the bond market believing inflation is headed back toward 2%. Until that happens, rates stay where they are regardless of what the Fed does on any single day.

Monthly P&I on a \$300K purchase, 25% down



What a rate move is worth. On a \$300K purchase with 25% down (\$225K loan), every half point on the rate is worth roughly \$75 a month, or about \$900 a year. That matters, but on a rental it is a line item, not the whole deal. A \$50 rent difference between two comparable houses, or \$2,000 in seller-paid closing costs, moves the numbers just as much. Buy the right property at the right price and the rate becomes something you fix later with a refinance. Buy the wrong property because the rate was good and there is no fixing it.

Why Pittsburgh handles high rates better than most markets.

- **Lower price points, smaller dollar impact.** A half point on a \$300K house is \$75 a month. On a \$700K house in a coastal market it is \$175. Rate moves simply hurt less here.
- **It is a cash-flow market, not an appreciation bet.** Pittsburgh never ran up 40% in 2021, so it has nothing to give back. Investors here buy on rent versus payment, and rents have kept pace. Markets that depended on cheap money and price growth are the ones correcting.
- **Sellers adjust before buyers give up.** Rising inventory and a wider list-to-sale gap are the market doing exactly that. Higher rates are pushing sellers to negotiate on price, credits, and rate buydowns, which is where a buyer's leverage comes from right now.
- **Fewer competing buyers.** Every point on the rate knocks some buyers out. In a 3.5-month-supply market that is what turns bidding wars into normal negotiations.

What to do with this

- **Buy the deal, not the rate.** Underwrite at today's rate (7% to 7.5% for an investment loan). If it works at 7.5%, a refinance later is upside, not a rescue.
- **Use the leverage while it is here.** More inventory and motivated sellers mean seller-paid closing costs, temporary rate buydowns (a 2-1 buydown can cut year-one payments by \$200 or more a month), and price reductions on anything past 45 days on market.

- **Fall and winter are the buying season for investors.** The summer buyers are gone, days on market stretch, and sellers who need to move before year end negotiate. Historically this is when my clients get the best terms.
- **Have a rate plan, not a rate prediction.** Lock when the payment works for you. If rates fall a full point, refinance. If they do not, you own a property that already penciled at the higher number.

Bottom line. Prices are up, homes are moving faster than a year ago, and there is finally more to choose from. Rates are high and likely to stay there through winter, which is exactly why the next few months favor buyers who are ready. If you want to look at specific deals against these numbers, I run every property through the same rent-versus-payment screen before it goes to a client.

Sources: West Penn Multi-List market statistics, September 2024 to September 2026 (average sale price, average days on market, active listing count, MLS-wide); Federal Reserve FOMC statement, September 16, 2026; Freddie Mac PMMS and Zillow daily rate data, week of September 14, 2026. Payment figures are principal and interest only at the stated rate on a 30-year fixed loan and exclude taxes and insurance. June peak figures are approximate. This is a market overview, not a guarantee of future performance or a substitute for property-specific analysis.